

3. It cannot access the member names directly, and uses an object name and dot operator with each member name

An illustration is shown below.

```
# include <iostream.h>
class s1
{
    int a;
    int b;
public:
    void set() { a=50; b=40;}
    friend float m1(s1 s);
};

float m1(s1 s)
{
    return float(s.a + s.b)/2.0;
}

int main()
{
    s1 k;
    k.set();
    cout<<" Mean value = " <<m1(k) <<"\n";
    return 0;
}
```

The output of this program is:

Mean value = 45

Here, `m1()` is declared as a friend function. The function accesses both the variables `a` and `b` with the help of the dot operator and the object passed to it. The function calls `m1(k)` within the main function passes the object `k` by value to the friend function. The friend function `m1()` that is declared inside the class `s1` is defined outside the class. This function finds the mean of the two values assigned to the variables `a` and `b`.